

OBSTACLES TO GRACE

* Blue denotes PPT slide

* Brown denotes instructions to technician

Titus 3:3-7 (NKJV) *“For we ourselves also were sometimes foolish, disobedient, deceived, serving divers lusts and pleasures, living in malice and envy, hateful, and hating one another. 4 But after that the kindness and love of God our Saviour toward man appeared, 5 Not by works of righteousness which we have done, but according to his mercy he saved us, by the washing of regeneration, and renewing of the Holy Ghost; 6 Which he shed on us abundantly through Jesus Christ our Saviour; 7 That being justified by his grace, we should be made heirs according to the hope of eternal life.”*

INTRO: Mercy is not getting what I do deserve:

- I didn't get punished for my sin, which I did deserve
- I didn't go to hell for the payment of my sin, which I did deserve
- I didn't get cut off from God for my sin, which I did deserve
- I didn't get ratted out for every mistake I have made, which I did deserve

(Talk about the mercy meter – God's mercies are new every morning)

Grace is getting what I do not deserve:

- I don't deserve a good life, but I am living a good life
- I don't deserve the family I have, but I have them
- I don't deserve the house I live in, or the car I drive, but I have them
- I don't deserve to pastor this church, but I am here

Sin is missing the mark. Grace covers my sin. An obstacle is anything that stands between us and our goals and dreams.

When we face an obstacle we have to devise a plan to overcome it. This sermon is about helping us overcome the obstacles to grace in our lives.

I. OBSTACLES TO GRACE

Paul writing to the Galatians makes an interesting statement about grace.

Galatians 2:21 (KJV) *“I do not frustrate the grace of God...”* This scripture gave me heartburn for years. If grace is getting what I do not deserve how can I frustrate grace? The answer is in the latter part of the verse. *“I do not frustrate the grace of God: for if righteousness come by the law, then Christ is dead in vain.”* One can frustrate the grace of God by adding to it or taking away from it. Ephesians 2:8 (KJV) *“For by grace are ye saved*

through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God.” We are saved by grace through the finished work of Christ, and nothing else!

Two powerful obstacles to grace are...
(Place on screen one at a time)

- 1) **Sin** – Of course, sin prevents a person from being able to receive the grace of God. (Self loathing) Sin in the life of the believer prevents the believer from being able to accept grace. Sin in the life of the believer is a confidence killer when we pray and approach God. (Cast not away your confidence...)
- 2) **The World** – 1 John 2:16 (KJV) ***“For all that is in the world, the lust of the flesh, and the lust of the eyes, and the pride of life, is not of the Father, but is of the world.”***
 - A) Lust of the flesh = Sex, lust & perversion

- B) Lust of the eye = Possessions, position & power
- C) Pride of life = Always needing to be number one, willing to tear others down to build oneself up & bragging rights

II. HOW DO WE OVERCOME THE OBSTACLES TO GRACE?

- 1) Become crucified with Christ
- 2) Die to self
- 3) Obedience to God
- 4) Put on Christ
- 5) Fellowship with other believers

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PLACES PREACHED:

CT Staff Chapel 10/13/15

CT 9:00 10/18/15 AM

CT Legacy 10/18/15